



Grade 10 FAST ELA Reading

Spring 2024 Released Test Items

Passage 1: from *Gods and Heroes*

by Carl Friedrich Becker and Ferdinand Schmidt

This is the myth of Sisyphus, who tried to outsmart the Greek gods and was sentenced to push a boulder up a mountain for all eternity.

1 Sisyphus was in the same dreadful place. In the upper world he had been guilty of thefts both among men and the gods. In the very hour of his death he perpetrated an evil deed. He seized and bound Thanatos, the god of death, with brazen bands, and for a long time no one died on earth. The gods of the underworld sent to Zeus this message: "Behold Thanatos, who went to the upper world to bring Sisyphus here, has not returned. For several days no shade¹ has entered our dark kingdom." Thereupon Zeus sent for the powerful war god, Ares, and ordered him to find the god of death. He soon found and released him from his fetters, and Sisyphus was taken to the underworld by Thanatos. Even then he continued his deceitful deeds. He said to his wife: "Do not bury my body and make the customary death offering to the gods of the underworld." Then he appeared before Hades and Persephone and said: "My wife has not buried my body and has neglected to make the death offering. Let me go to her and remind the faithless one of her duty. Then I surely will return."

2 His wish was granted and he returned to the upper world. As he did not come back, word was again sent to Zeus, who dispatched the swift-flying Hermes to take the deceiver back. When Sisyphus saw the divine messenger, his courage gave way, for he knew that no mortal could outdo him in cunning. Hermes took him back to the dark kingdom, where a fearful penalty awaited him. He had to roll a huge block of marble up a high mountain which no sooner reached the top than it went thundering down. He had to begin his task over again with sweat of toil and anguish dropping from his brow to the earth.

¹shade: spirit

Excerpt from *Gods and Heroes* by Carl Friedrich Becker and Ferdinand Schmidt. In the public domain.

Passage 2: Scarabaeus Sisyphus

by Mathilde Blind

This poem describes the scarab, a type of beetle that creates balls of mud in order to feed.

1 I've watched thee, Scarab! Yea, an hour in vain
I've watched thee, slowly toiling up the hill,
Pushing thy lump of mud before thee still
With patience infinite and stubborn strain.
5 Strive as thou mayest, spare neither time nor pain.
To screen thy burden from all chance of ill;
Push, push, with all a beetle's force of will,
Thy ball, alas! rolls ever down again.

Toil without end! And why? That after thee
10 Dim hosts of groping Scarabs too shall climb
This self-same height? Accurséd progeny
Of Sisyphus, what antenatal crime
Has doomed us too to roll incessantly
Life's Stone, recoiling from the Alps of time?

"Scarabaeus Sisyphus" by Mathilde Blind, from Poetical Works of Mathilde Blind. In the public domain.

Passage 3: Sisyphus's Confession

In this poem, the author imagines what Sisyphus might have said if he could explain his actions and his understanding of the Greek mythological afterlife.

15 I'll admit, the first few times were agony (pure anguish).
I could barely move that rock and felt my hope near-extinguish.
Slow step by step, I heaved my burden and tried to set my will.
Drip, drap, drop, the gods cackled as I sweated on that hill.

I let them laugh, even stumbled a bit to encourage them to jest.
20 I made a great show of huffing and heaving and all the rest.
They bought it, of course, thanks to their hubris.
They assume I suffer—that no mortal would choose this.

Why do you think I wanted to outwit death—
that I cared if I took another breath?
25 Here, my lungs toil tirelessly, my limbs are lead,
but what an alternative to being dead!

In body and in flesh, no man can truly live forever.
But let the world know my deeds, or simply that I was clever.
Whether here or there, all will know the name
30 of Sisyphus, who nearly beat the gods at their own game.

Who—no, what would I be had I accepted my lot?
A dark shadow, incapable of even a single thought.
Give me the struggle, then the satisfaction,
Even resentment is better than facing oblivion.

35 Now I set my hardened, calloused shoulder
into the familiar dips and valleys of my boulder.
I feel a smirk threaten to spread across my face.
Finally, the kind of storied destiny I can truly embrace.

But this quiet kind of contentment, I dare not let show.
40 What would the gods do next, should they know?

"Sisyphus's Confession" written for educational purposes.

1. Read these sentences from Passage 1.

“. . . ‘My wife has not buried my body and has neglected to make the death offering. Let me go to her and remind the faithless one of her duty. Then I surely will return.’” (paragraph 1)

How does Sisyphus’s statement add irony to the passage?

- Ⓐ He is shaming her for neglect even though he abandoned her.
- Ⓑ He is asking to remind her even though he is the one who forgot.
- Ⓒ He is calling his wife faithless even though he is the deceitful one.
- Ⓓ He is speaking of duty even though he is avoiding his responsibility to her.

2. This question has two parts. First, answer Part A. Then, answer Part B.

Part A

Which **two** universal themes are present in Passage 1?

- Ⓐ teamwork as salvation
- Ⓑ accountability for actions
- Ⓒ trickery as rebellious behavior
- Ⓓ change of fate as a result of devotion
- Ⓔ the emptiness of attaining an immoral goal

Part B

How are the universal themes in Part A related?

- Ⓐ They connect emotions to decisions.
- Ⓑ They link decisions to condemnation.
- Ⓒ They show the effects of achievement.
- Ⓓ They demonstrate a method of achievement.

3. Read this sentence from Passage 1.

“When Sisyphus saw the divine messenger, his courage gave way, for he knew that no mortal could outdo him in cunning.” (paragraph 2)

How does this description create a hopeless mood?

- Ⓐ It shows that Sisyphus yields because he realizes his future is inescapable.
- Ⓑ It reveals that Sisyphus relents because he has already proven his strength.
- Ⓒ It implies that Sisyphus resists because he knows the messenger is powerful.
- Ⓓ It shows that Sisyphus surrenders because he does not have time to make a plan.

4. Read the excerpt from Passage 2.

"I've watched thee, Scarab! Yea, an hour in vain
I've watched thee, slowly toiling up the hill," (lines 1–2)

What does the repetition in these lines reveal?

- Ⓐ the importance of the beetle's work
- Ⓑ the speaker's fascination with the beetle
- Ⓒ the attention that the beetle pays to its task
- Ⓓ the relationship of the speaker to the beetle

5. Read these lines from Passage 2.

“This self-same height? Accurséd progeny / Of Sisyphus, what
antenatal crime” (lines 11–12)

The root word “ante” means “previous.” What does antenatal crime reference in these lines?

- Ⓐ the fault of those born over time
- Ⓑ the error of those born before us
- Ⓒ the offense of being born on time
- Ⓓ the injustice of being born too soon

- 6.** Passage 2 offers an alternative interpretation of Sisyphus’s struggle from Passage 1. How does this reinterpretation affect the meaning of Passage 2?
- Ⓐ It affirms how important the struggle is.
 - Ⓑ It reveals the difficulty of the experience.
 - Ⓒ It exposes the insignificance of the struggle.
 - Ⓓ It highlights that the experience is universal.

7. How does stanza 2 of Passage 3 develop a different aspect of Sisyphus's experience than the version in Passage 1?
- Ⓐ In Passage 3 he is continuing to fool the gods.
 - Ⓑ In Passage 3 he is steadily improving at his task.
 - Ⓒ In Passage 3 he is putting in more physical effort.
 - Ⓓ In Passage 3 he is enjoying the happiness of the gods.

8. What does the word oblivion mean as it is used in line 34 of Passage 3?

- Ⓐ the state of being confused
- Ⓑ the state of being forgotten
- Ⓒ the shape and length of time
- Ⓓ the position and order of loss

- 9.** What idea is left unclear in the final stanza of Passage 3?
- Ⓐ what consequence would truly punish Sisyphus
 - Ⓑ what motivates Sisyphus to continue his deception
 - Ⓒ whether Sisyphus truly suffered while doing his task
 - Ⓓ whether Sisyphus brought about his own punishment for glory

10. This question has two parts. First, answer Part A. Then, answer Part B.

Part A

What is the mood in Passage 3?

- Ⓐ peaceful
- Ⓑ smug
- Ⓒ vengeful
- Ⓓ weary

Part B

Which line from Passage 3 shows how the mood in Part A is developed through figurative language?

- Ⓐ “Drip, drap, drop, the gods cackled as I sweated on that hill.” (line 18)
- Ⓑ “Here, my lungs toil tirelessly, my limbs are lead” (line 25)
- Ⓒ “into the familiar dips and valleys of my boulder.” (line 36)
- Ⓓ “Finally, the kind of storied destiny I can truly embrace.” (line 38)

11. This question has two parts. First, answer Part A. Then, answer Part B.

Part A

How has the character of Sisyphus in Passage 3 changed from the original work in Passage 1?

- Ⓐ Sisyphus rests in peace.
- Ⓑ Sisyphus ends his suffering.
- Ⓒ Sisyphus retains his free will.
- Ⓓ Sisyphus disrespects the gods.

Part B

Select **two** lines from Passage 3 that support the answer in Part A.

- Ⓐ "I'll admit, the first few times were agony (pure anguish)." (line 15)
- Ⓑ "I could barely move that rock and felt my hope near-extinguish." (line 16)
- Ⓒ "Drip, drap, drop, the gods cackled as I sweated on that hill." (line 18)
- Ⓓ "Who—no, what would I be had I accepted my lot?" (line 31)
- Ⓔ "But this quiet kind of contentment, I dare not let show." (line 39)

Remarks at the 1964 Dedication of the Smithsonian Institution's Museum of History and Technology

by Lyndon B. Johnson

1 The gathering of knowledge is the supreme achievement of man.

2 Four hundred years ago, Francis Bacon could immodestly declare:
"I have taken all knowledge to be my province." Bacon would find this
new Museum of History and Technology of the Smithsonian Institution
to his taste, and to his aims.

3 For I believe this new museum will do that which causes us all to
celebrate: it will excite a thirst for knowledge—and to promote it for
all the people.

4 My earliest predecessor, George Washington, in a letter to the
officers of the American Philosophical Society, founded in Philadelphia
by Franklin, wrote these words:

5 "If I have a wish ungratified, it is that the arts and sciences may
continue to flourish with increasing lustre."

6 It was also Washington who said, in his Farewell Address:

7 "Promote, then, as an object of primary importance, institutions
for the general diffusion of knowledge. In proportion as the
structure of a government gives force to public opinion, it should be
enlightened."

8 So it pleases me a great deal tonight to come here to perform
the role of dedicator in this building of knowledge which is the inheritor
of all that has gone before.

9 Here, for all to see and for all to absorb, will be exhibited the
pageant of history of a youthful nation that is today as it was when
Jefferson described it: "In the full tide of successful experiment."

10 I would hope that there will come to this building the children of
the Nation. For here is recorded, as William Faulkner expressed it, the
agony and the sweat of the human spirit, the victory of the freedom
and the genius of our country. Here, young children see, with their
own eyes, yes, even touch with their own hands, the ripe fruit of
America's historical harvest.

11 Whitney's cotton gin, Singer's sewing machine, McCormick's
reaper, Edison's phonograph, Bell's telephone—they are all here, a part
of this treasure-house of our inheritance.

12 The more we understand the meaning of the past, the more we
appreciate the winning of the future.

- 13 I hope that every schoolchild who visits this Capital, every foreign visitor who comes to this First City, and every doubter who hesitates before the onrush of tomorrow will, some way, spend some time in this great museum. In truth, this new museum could become an open window through which could look the children of Asia and Western Europe and South America and the Soviet Union.
- 14 What greater thrust toward peace is there than the invitation to young people of the world, particularly those behind the Iron Curtain, to come visit us and to see this museum of history?
- 15 Why not open our historical doors and let the visitors see what kind of people we really are—and what sort of people we really come from?
- 16 They would instantly realize that we were not always the affluent nation and the powerful nation and the fortunate nation. From the exhibits in this museum they would learn that the demagogues' dingy slogans around the world have no real basis in fact.
- 17 Our ancestors moved across the prairies, working to build something where nothing existed before. Yes, this museum would show to the skeptics and the doubters that what we have today was wrenched out of the earth and the sweat of pioneers who, in the face of a thousand disappointments, refused to ever abandon the American dream.
- 18 We would show the visitors from the newly emerging nations that their labors are not in vain—for the future belongs to those who work for it. Let them go back to their home secure in the knowledge that from coarse and barren beginnings come the fulfillments of hope. They will have seen the evidence here.
- 19 If this museum did nothing more than illuminate our heritage so that others could see a little better our legacy, however so small the glimpse, it would fulfill a most noble purpose.
- 20 I am so glad to be here with you tonight.
- 21 I am always glad to be where America is.

"Remarks at the Dedication of the Smithsonian Institution's Museum of History and Technology"
by Lyndon B. Johnson. In the public domain.

12. Select the word that comes from the Latin root for “light, brightness.”

4 My earliest Ⓐ predecessor, George Washington, in a letter to the officers of the American Ⓑ Philosophical Society, founded in Philadelphia by Franklin, wrote these words:

5 “If I have a wish Ⓒ ungratified, it is that the arts and sciences may continue to Ⓓ flourish with increasing Ⓔ lustre.”

Grade 10 FAST ELA Reading

13. Complete the table to indicate which role each section has in the development of ideas in the passage.

	Paragraph 1	Paragraphs 2–3	Paragraphs 4–7
establishing how museums can be considered patriotic	Ⓐ	Ⓑ	Ⓒ
providing a claim about why the museum should be celebrated	Ⓓ	Ⓔ	Ⓕ
placing the function of museums among humankind’s other accomplishments	Ⓖ	Ⓗ	Ⓖ

14. The word “diffusion” comes from the Latin word for “pour out.” Based on this information, what is the meaning of diffusion as it is used in paragraph 7?

- Ⓐ gathering
- Ⓑ leak
- Ⓒ research
- Ⓓ spread

15. How does Johnson use quotations to support his credibility?

- Ⓐ He implies that he is popular among his peers.
- Ⓑ He provides expert opinions on a topic unfamiliar to him.
- Ⓒ He shows he has considered the opinions of his opponents.
- Ⓓ He suggests that other notable figures would agree with him.

16. How does paragraph 11 support the central idea that the museum will have an impressive collection?

- Ⓐ by listing the more expensive exhibits
- Ⓑ by describing the most popular exhibits
- Ⓒ by highlighting historically important exhibits
- Ⓓ by ranking the inventors responsible for the exhibits

17. How do the rhetorical questions in paragraphs 14 and 15 support Johnson's argument?

- Ⓐ They imply that Johnson is open to hearing suggestions from others.
- Ⓑ They imply that Johnson is telling the audience something they already know.
- Ⓒ They imply that Johnson is confident in his position about the museum's importance.
- Ⓓ They imply that Johnson thinks some people may benefit more from the museum than others.

18. How does Johnson's reference to other countries in paragraph 18 support his rhetoric?

- Ⓐ It appeals to logic by identifying which countries need help.
- Ⓑ It appeals to logic by emphasizing which countries he has visited.
- Ⓒ It appeals to emotions by identifying parallels with other countries.
- Ⓓ It appeals to emotions by emphasizing the barriers between countries.

19. Read these paragraphs from the passage.

20 I am so glad to be here with you tonight.

21 I'm always glad to be where America is.

How does the rhetoric in these paragraphs support Johnson's overall purpose?

- Ⓐ The logical appeal provides a new conclusion.
- Ⓑ The logical appeal summarizes the argument.
- Ⓒ The emotional appeal adds a final speculation.
- Ⓓ The emotional appeal creates a personal connection.

20. Select **two** ways in which Johnson creates emotional appeals to support his purpose.

- Ⓐ He shares his hopes in order to be inspirational.
- Ⓑ He generalizes about countries in order to educate his audience.
- Ⓒ He uses the conditional “if” to express uncertainty about the future.
- Ⓓ He uses the general “they” in order to exclude people he does not like.
- Ⓔ He uses the plural “we” in order to encourage the audience to agree with him.

- 21.** How does Johnson's exaggeration throughout the passage support the central idea that the museum is necessary?
- Ⓐ It suggests that the museum will have a strong impact on people.
 - Ⓑ It suggests that the museum will last for a long time into the future.
 - Ⓒ It suggests that the museum was created because he believed in it.
 - Ⓓ It suggests that the museum is unlike anything else already in existence.

***from* The Piano Lesson**

by August Wilson

Permissions were not secured for the use of this passage on a public website. For your reference, the citation for the passage and for items 23, 24, and 28 is as follows: August Wilson, *The Piano Lesson* (New York: New American Library, 1988, 1990), Act 1, Scene 2.

22. What does the dialogue in paragraphs 13–15 reveal about Boy Willie?
Select **two** answers.

- Ⓐ He secretly worries that he is doing the wrong thing.
- Ⓑ He is dismissive of others' concerns about his actions.
- Ⓒ He feels the need to keep people from becoming close to him.
- Ⓓ He appreciates hearing other peoples' thoughts before he acts.
- Ⓔ He needs to appear strong and in control in front of other people.

23. Read this paragraph from the passage.

20 BERNIECE: That's just what I'm gonna do. Wining Boy, you want me to fry you some pork chops?

How does this paragraph develop the universal themes of honoring the past and caring for family?

- Ⓐ by narrowing Berniece's focus to the family's tangible concerns
- Ⓑ by having Berniece exclude Boy Willie from a family discussion due to his lack of respect
- Ⓒ by showing that Berniece considers the desires of both her living and deceased family members
- Ⓓ by contrasting Berniece's and Boy Willie's willingness to let the other members of the family make the decision

24. Read the sentences from the passage.

“Then that be something else, I’d have to go on and say, well, Berniece using that piano. She building on it. Let her go on and use it.”
(paragraph 21)

What is the meaning of the phrase “building on it” as it is used in the passage?

- Ⓐ designing something on top of
- Ⓑ purchasing something to match it
- Ⓒ establishing something by utilizing it
- Ⓓ constructing something out of the parts of

25. What effect does Berniece's use of repetition in paragraph 22 have on the passage?

- Ⓐ It helps shift Berniece's argument from the family's past to its present.
- Ⓑ It shows that Berniece is unwilling to listen to the arguments of others.
- Ⓒ It reinforces the emotional weight that the piano held for Berniece's mother.
- Ⓓ It supports the idea that Berniece is the best judge of what should happen to the piano.

26. How does paragraph 22 develop Boy Willie and Berniece's different perspectives on the family? Select **two** answers.

- Ⓐ by showing that they each remember their childhoods very differently
- Ⓑ by showing that they each identify more closely with one of their parents
- Ⓒ by showing that they have learned competing lessons from their childhoods
- Ⓓ by showing that they have conflicting feelings about the importance of the family
- Ⓔ by showing that they have different reasons for wanting to spend less time with family

27. What effect does the connection between Sutter’s Ghost and the piano have on the passage?

- Ⓐ It provides an additional reason for the family to want the piano gone.
- Ⓑ It reinforces the idea that the past has an ongoing influence on the present.
- Ⓒ It indicates that the family only has a limited amount of time to make a decision.
- Ⓓ It suggests that keeping the piano will have unforeseen consequences for everyone.

28. This question has two parts. First, answer Part A. Then, answer Part B.

Part A

How does the passage develop the universal themes of accountability to family and the acceptance of responsibility?

- Ⓐ Berniece prefers to focus on taking care of others and ignores Boy Willie's questions about the piano.
- Ⓑ Berniece and Boy Willie each check with other members of the family to try to gain support for their plans.
- Ⓒ Berniece and Boy Willie both want to do what is right for their family but have different ideas of how to do that.
- Ⓓ Boy Willie finds an alternative method of getting money while Berniece refuses to consider their financial obligations.

Part B

Select **two** details from the passage that support the answer in Part A.

- Ⓐ "Just as soon as I get them watermelons out that truck." (paragraph 6)
- Ⓑ "This is me and Berniece's piano. Am I right, Doaker?" (paragraph 10)
- Ⓒ "Money can't buy what that piano cost. You can't sell your soul for money." (paragraph 18)
- Ⓓ "Papa Boy Charles brought that piano into the house. Now, I'm supposed to build on what they left me." (paragraph 21)
- Ⓔ "You always talking about your daddy but you ain't never stopped to look at what his foolishness cost your mama." (paragraph 22)

Passage 1:

H.R. 51: Making D.C. the 51st State

by Representative Elijah E. Cummings

This is the opening statement of Representative Elijah E. Cummings of Maryland, chairman of the U.S. House Committee on Oversight and Reform, at a hearing about a bill to make certain portions of Washington, D.C., the 51st state of the United States.

1 I am extremely proud that our committee is holding the first hearing on D.C. Statehood in the House of Representatives in more than 25 years. Neither chamber of Congress has ever passed a Statehood bill. I hope ours will be the first.

2 H.R. 51 now has 220 cosponsors, which is a record for any previous D.C. Statehood bill. For the first time in a generation, there is real and sustained momentum behind this effort. This legislation would fulfill the promise of democracy for more than 700,000 Americans who call Washington, D.C., their home.

3 D.C. residents are American citizens. . . . They pay taxes. Not many people know this, but D.C. pays more in total Federal taxes than the residents of 22 states. And it pays more per capita than any state in the Nation.

4 D.C. residents have all of the responsibilities of citizenship, but they have no congressional voting rights and only limited self-government. These fundamental disparities for hundreds of thousands of Americans are inconsistent with the core principles embodied in our Constitution.

5 When our Nation was founded, it was based on the belief that no people should be subjected to taxation without representation or be governed without their consent. The Boston Tea Party was one of the most famous illustrations of this fight, refusing to accept laws and taxes in which they had no say.

6 Everyone on this panel, in this room, and across the country should be able to agree with this core value. . . .

7 There is nothing more fundamental in a democracy than the right to vote. As the Supreme Court has said—and I am quoting the Court—“No right is more precious in a free country than that of having a voice in the election of those who make the laws under which, as good citizens, we must live. Other rights, even the most basic, are illusory if the right to vote is undermined.”

8 In President Dwight D. Eisenhower’s 1956 State of the Union

address, he said this. “Once again, I ask the Congress to join with me in demonstrating our belief in the right of suffrage. I renew my request that the principle of self-government be extended and the right of suffrage granted to the citizens of the District of Columbia.”

9 Today, more than 60 years after President Eisenhower said those words, D.C. residents overwhelmingly support Statehood. In 2016, an astonishing 86 percent voted in favor of becoming a state.

10 The Congress now has an opportunity to live up to the Constitution’s goals. Statehood will give D.C. residents full and equal democratic rights. . . .

11 Today, I urge all members of this panel to rise above our partisan differences and think through this issue on the merits. I urge everyone to have a respectful and robust debate with the fundamental goals of our Founding Fathers at the forefront of our debate.

12 As President Abraham Lincoln declared in the Gettysburg Address, “A true democracy is government of the people, by the people, and for the people.”

Excerpt from “H.R. 51: Making D.C. the 51st State” by Representative Elijah E. Cummings, September 19, 2019. In the public domain.

Passage 2: Equality for the District of Columbia: Discussing the Implications of S. 132, the New Columbia Admission Act of 2013

by Senator Tom Coburn

This is the opening statement of U.S. Senator Tom Coburn of Oklahoma at a hearing about passing a bill to make a new state out of Washington, D.C., called “New Columbia.”

13 Since 1888, there have been hundreds of bills and amendments proposed to address D.C. representation. Since 1964, Congress has held no less than 10 hearings on it.

14 The House debated statehood in 1992. They heard from over a dozen witnesses and got another 20 opinions from every segment of the government.

15 Witnesses identified numerous problems, from constitutional to financial to administrative. The 1992 minority staff report does an excellent job of laying them out.

- 16 Yet here we are again debating this issue, even though it has no chance of success in this chamber, and is dead on arrival in the House.
- 17 This bill makes a state out of the neutral land that houses the Federal government. It's unprecedented.
- 18 Yet little effort was made to hold a hearing that seriously debates this bill.
- 19 More than half the witnesses are D.C. politicians, all with the same agenda and voicing the same interests.
- 20 With the exception of a witness I invited, none of the witnesses here provide an alternate opinion.
- 21 You can learn a lot about the seriousness of this hearing by looking at who is not here.
- 22 Where is the Department of Justice?
- 23 Every Department of Justice that has issued a report or testified about legislated D.C. statehood—(Kennedy, Carter, Reagan, Bush, Sr.) has concluded it is unconstitutional and would come with other extremely complex legal challenges.
- 24 Where is CBO, OMB, the Interior, Transportation, State, Defense, the General Services Administration, and Treasury?
- 25 D.C. statehood would significantly affect the Federal government's operations including: use and access to water and sewer services, utilities, police and fire services, infrastructure, communication networks, D.C. National Guard, D.C.'s unfunded liabilities and other benefits, and ability to control the aesthetics and condition of our nation's capital.
- 26 D.C. statehood would also come at an unknown cost to the U.S.
- 27 Who is representing the interests of other states?
- 28 D.C. statehood would significantly affect the sovereignty of other states, becoming the first among equals.
- 29 Nothing in the bill prevents New Columbia from still getting the special funding D.C. gets, approximately \$674 million each year just by virtue of being the nation's capital.
- 30 D.C. residents got more than eight times the national average of federal aid per capita, and more than two times the next highest state.
- 31 Who is here to represent Virginia and Maryland?
- 32 There is a serious question as to whether Maryland's consent would be necessary to create a new state, since it gave the land to be the Capital.

- 33 The bill even gives New Columbia control over certain land in Virginia and Maryland, a serious affront to their sovereignty.
- 34 D.C. residents suffer an injustice by not having a vote, but Congress can't bypass the constitutional amendment process simply because it's inconvenient.
- 35 The framers¹ designed the district to be an autonomous federal area, separate from any state's influence and different from all other federal land. It is patently false to say the framers could not have predicted the city would thrive: the District was envisioned prior to 1800 as a large, powerful city with 800,000 people—more than D.C. has now, and more than even Paris had at the time.
- 36 President Kennedy's Attorney General² said Congress can't reduce the district's size any more than it can remove a state from the Union.
- 37 Attorney General Kennedy said a small enclave clearly does not meet the concept of the permanent seat of government, which the framers held.
- 38 President Reagan's Attorney General said he would recommend the President veto any bill providing statehood without a constitutional amendment.

¹framers: the authors of the Constitution

²President Kennedy's Attorney General: Robert F. Kennedy

Excerpt from "Equality for the District of Columbia: Discussing the Implications of S. 132, the New Columbia Admission Act of 2013" by Senator Tom Coburn, September 15, 2014. In the public domain.

29. Read this sentence from Passage 1.

“Other rights, even the most basic, are illusory if the right to vote is undermined.” (paragraph 7)

What is the meaning of illusory as it is used in this sentence?

- Ⓐ meaningless
- Ⓑ simplistic
- Ⓒ unlawful
- Ⓓ unwise

30. In paragraphs 5 through 9 of Passage 1, how does Cummings support the central idea that a bill for D.C. statehood is ready to be passed?

- Ⓐ by emphasizing the hope that came from previous bills
- Ⓑ by explaining that the bill will reduce taxes on residents
- Ⓒ by demonstrating the demand for such a bill among citizens
- Ⓓ by claiming that members of Congress are eager to vote for the bill

31. In Passage 1, what strategy does Cummings frequently use to add an emotional appeal to his argument?

- Ⓐ emphasizing American ideals
- Ⓑ investigating American history
- Ⓒ confirming American greatness
- Ⓓ presenting data about American voters

32. Select **two** approaches that Cummings uses to create a favorable opinion about H.R. 51 in Passage 1.

- Ⓐ sharing the expectation of greater government revenue
- Ⓑ fostering a sense of unified purpose among representatives
- Ⓒ presenting the bill as something that will correct an injustice
- Ⓓ demonstrating that the founders intended to make D.C. a state
- Ⓔ suggesting that passing the bill would help his colleagues get reelected

33. Read this sentence from Passage 2.

16 Yet here we are again debating this issue, even though it has no chance of success in this chamber, and is dead on arrival in the House.

How does the phrase “dead on arrival” contribute to the pessimistic mood of the passage?

- Ⓐ It generates fear.
- Ⓑ It inspires outrage.
- Ⓒ It establishes confusion.
- Ⓓ It expresses uselessness.

34. In Passage 2, what is a reason Coburn uses short rhetorical questions starting in paragraph 22?

- Ⓐ to address complaints in the statehood bill
- Ⓑ to introduce arguments against the statehood bill
- Ⓒ to distract from the strengths of the statehood bill
- Ⓓ to downplay the power of the government to enact the statehood bill

- 35.** In paragraphs 23–25 of Passage 2, Coburn transitions from a history of failed bills to the effects of making D.C. a state. How does this strengthen his case?
- Ⓐ by establishing that such bills are unconstitutional
 - Ⓑ by emphasizing the reasons such bills continue to fail
 - Ⓒ by providing a contrast with arguments in favor of such bills
 - Ⓓ by suggesting that such bills were never intended to pass as written

36. Read this paragraph from Passage 2.

33 The bill even gives New Columbia control over certain land in Virginia and Maryland, a serious affront to their sovereignty.

What is the meaning of the phrase affront to their sovereignty in this context?

- Ⓐ violation of their laws
- Ⓑ attack on their traditions
- Ⓒ insult to their independence
- Ⓓ outrage against their senators

37. Select **two** ways in which Coburn argues that D.C. statehood would be unfair to the American people in Passage 2.

- Ⓐ by noting that not everyone is in favor of statehood
- Ⓑ by pointing out the area is not large enough to be a state
- Ⓒ by focusing on the financial difficulties statehood would create
- Ⓓ by implying that the new state would get preferential treatment
- Ⓔ by stating that the only people who support statehood are politicians

38. How do both speakers use information about early America to make their arguments?

- Ⓐ Both explain why D.C. was made the capital city.
- Ⓑ Both refer to the intentions of American founders.
- Ⓒ Both acknowledge the influence of European governments.
- Ⓓ Both portray Americans during the revolution as demanding.

39. Complete the table to show how each passage develops its argument.

How Passage Develops Its Argument	Passage 1	Passage 2	Both Passages
by appealing to the values of democracy	(A)	(B)	(C)
by referring to principles of the Constitution	(D)	(E)	(F)
by using detailed specifics about related laws	(G)	(H)	(I)



Grade 10 FAST ELA Reading

Test Release: 2024

Passage 1: from *Gods and Heroes*

by Carl Friedrich Becker and Ferdinand Schmidt

This is the myth of Sisyphus, who tried to outsmart the Greek gods and was sentenced to push a boulder up a mountain for all eternity.

1 Sisyphus was in the same dreadful place. In the upper world he had been guilty of thefts both among men and the gods. In the very hour of his death he perpetrated an evil deed. He seized and bound Thanatos, the god of death, with brazen bands, and for a long time no one died on earth. The gods of the underworld sent to Zeus this message: "Behold Thanatos, who went to the upper world to bring Sisyphus here, has not returned. For several days no shade¹ has entered our dark kingdom." Thereupon Zeus sent for the powerful war god, Ares, and ordered him to find the god of death. He soon found and released him from his fetters, and Sisyphus was taken to the underworld by Thanatos. Even then he continued his deceitful deeds. He said to his wife: "Do not bury my body and make the customary death offering to the gods of the underworld." Then he appeared before Hades and Persephone and said: "My wife has not buried my body and has neglected to make the death offering. Let me go to her and remind the faithless one of her duty. Then I surely will return."

2 His wish was granted and he returned to the upper world. As he did not come back, word was again sent to Zeus, who dispatched the swift-flying Hermes to take the deceiver back. When Sisyphus saw the divine messenger, his courage gave way, for he knew that no mortal could outdo him in cunning. Hermes took him back to the dark kingdom, where a fearful penalty awaited him. He had to roll a huge block of marble up a high mountain which no sooner reached the top than it went thundering down. He had to begin his task over again with sweat of toil and anguish dropping from his brow to the earth.

¹shade: spirit

Excerpt from *Gods and Heroes* by Carl Friedrich Becker and Ferdinand Schmidt. In the public domain.

Passage 2: Scarabaeus Sisyphus

by Mathilde Blind

This poem describes the scarab, a type of beetle that creates balls of mud in order to feed.

- 1 I've watched thee, Scarab! Yea, an hour in vain
I've watched thee, slowly toiling up the hill,
Pushing thy lump of mud before thee still
With patience infinite and stubborn strain.
5 Strive as thou mayest, spare neither time nor pain.
To screen thy burden from all chance of ill;
Push, push, with all a beetle's force of will,
Thy ball, alas! rolls ever down again.

- 10 Toil without end! And why? That after thee
Dim hosts of groping Scarabs too shall climb
This self-same height? Accurséd progeny
Of Sisyphus, what antenatal crime
Has doomed us too to roll incessantly
Life's Stone, recoiling from the Alps of time?

"Scarabaeus Sisyphus" by Mathilde Blind, from Poetical Works of Mathilde Blind. In the public domain.

Passage 3: Sisyphus's Confession

In this poem, the author imagines what Sisyphus might have said if he could explain his actions and his understanding of the Greek mythological afterlife.

15 I'll admit, the first few times were agony (pure anguish).
I could barely move that rock and felt my hope near-extinguish.
Slow step by step, I heaved my burden and tried to set my will.
Drip, drap, drop, the gods cackled as I sweated on that hill.

I let them laugh, even stumbled a bit to encourage them to jest.
20 I made a great show of huffing and heaving and all the rest.
They bought it, of course, thanks to their hubris.
They assume I suffer—that no mortal would choose this.

Why do you think I wanted to outwit death—
that I cared if I took another breath?
25 Here, my lungs toil tirelessly, my limbs are lead,
but what an alternative to being dead!

In body and in flesh, no man can truly live forever.
But let the world know my deeds, or simply that I was clever.
Whether here or there, all will know the name
30 of Sisyphus, who nearly beat the gods at their own game.

Who—no, what would I be had I accepted my lot?
A dark shadow, incapable of even a single thought.
Give me the struggle, then the satisfaction,
Even resentment is better than facing oblivion.

35 Now I set my hardened, calloused shoulder
into the familiar dips and valleys of my boulder.
I feel a smirk threaten to spread across my face.
Finally, the kind of storied destiny I can truly embrace.

But this quiet kind of contentment, I dare not let show.
40 What would the gods do next, should they know?

"Sisyphus's Confession" written for educational purposes.

Florida Test Release Support Document

1. Read these sentences from Passage 1.

“. . . ‘My wife has not buried my body and has neglected to make the death offering. Let me go to her and remind the faithless one of her duty. Then I surely will return.’” (paragraph 1)

How does Sisyphus’s statement add irony to the passage?

- Ⓐ He is shaming her for neglect even though he abandoned her.
- Ⓑ He is asking to remind her even though he is the one who forgot.
- Ⓒ He is calling his wife faithless even though he is the deceitful one.
- Ⓓ He is speaking of duty even though he is avoiding his responsibility to her.

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 60%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.10.R.1.1

Benchmark Description: Analyze how key elements enhance or add layers of meaning and/or style in a literary text.

2. This question has two parts. First, answer Part A. Then, answer Part B.

Part A

Which **two** universal themes are present in Passage 1?

- Ⓐ teamwork as salvation
- Ⓑ accountability for actions
- Ⓒ trickery as rebellious behavior
- Ⓓ change of fate as a result of devotion
- Ⓔ the emptiness of attaining an immoral goal

Part B

How are the universal themes in Part A related?

- Ⓐ They connect emotions to decisions.
- Ⓑ They link decisions to condemnation.
- Ⓒ They show the effects of achievement.
- Ⓓ They demonstrate a method of achievement.

Answer Key: B, C and B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 24%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.10.R.1.2

Benchmark Description: Analyze and compare universal themes and their development throughout a literary text.

3. Read this sentence from Passage 1.

“When Sisyphus saw the divine messenger, his courage gave way, for he knew that no mortal could outdo him in cunning.” (paragraph 2)

How does this description create a hopeless mood?

- ☒ (A) It shows that Sisyphus yields because he realizes his future is inescapable.
- ☐ (B) It reveals that Sisyphus relents because he has already proven his strength.
- ☐ (C) It implies that Sisyphus resists because he knows the messenger is powerful.
- ☐ (D) It shows that Sisyphus surrenders because he does not have time to make a plan.

Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 50%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.10.R.3.1

Benchmark Description: Analyze how figurative language creates mood in text(s).

4. Read the excerpt from Passage 2.

"I've watched thee, Scarab! Yea, an hour in vain
I've watched thee, slowly toiling up the hill," (lines 1–2)

What does the repetition in these lines reveal?

- Ⓐ the importance of the beetle's work
- Ⓑ the speaker's fascination with the beetle
- Ⓒ the attention that the beetle pays to its task
- Ⓓ the relationship of the speaker to the beetle

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 42%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.10.R.1.4

Benchmark Description: Analyze how authors create multiple layers of meaning and/or ambiguity in a poem.

5. Read these lines from Passage 2.

“This self-same height? Accurséd progeny / Of Sisyphus, what
antenatal crime” (lines 11–12)

The root word “ante” means “previous.” What does antenatal crime reference in these lines?

- Ⓐ the fault of those born over time
- Ⓑ the error of those born before us
- Ⓒ the offense of being born on time
- Ⓓ the injustice of being born too soon

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 63%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.10.V.1.2

Benchmark Description: Apply knowledge of etymology and derivations to determine meanings of words and phrases in grade level content.

6. Passage 2 offers an alternative interpretation of Sisyphus’s struggle from Passage 1. How does this reinterpretation affect the meaning of Passage 2?
- Ⓐ It affirms how important the struggle is.
 - Ⓑ It reveals the difficulty of the experience.
 - Ⓒ It exposes the insignificance of the struggle.
 - Ⓓ It highlights that the experience is universal.

Answer Key: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 21%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.10.R.3.3

Benchmark Description: Analyze how mythical, classical, or religious texts have been adapted.

7. How does stanza 2 of Passage 3 develop a different aspect of Sisyphus's experience than the version in Passage 1?

- Ⓐ In Passage 3 he is continuing to fool the gods.
- Ⓑ In Passage 3 he is steadily improving at his task.
- Ⓒ In Passage 3 he is putting in more physical effort.
- Ⓓ In Passage 3 he is enjoying the happiness of the gods.

Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 52%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.10.R.3.3

Benchmark Description: Analyze how mythical, classical, or religious texts have been adapted.

8. What does the word oblivion mean as it is used in line 34 of Passage 3?

- Ⓐ the state of being confused
- Ⓑ the state of being forgotten
- Ⓒ the shape and length of time
- Ⓓ the position and order of loss

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 50%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.10.V.1.3

Benchmark Description: Apply knowledge of context clues, figurative language, word relationships, reference materials, and/or background knowledge to determine the connotative and denotative meaning of words and phrases, appropriate to grade level.

9. What idea is left unclear in the final stanza of Passage 3?

- Ⓐ what consequence would truly punish Sisyphus
- Ⓑ what motivates Sisyphus to continue his deception
- Ⓒ whether Sisyphus truly suffered while doing his task
- Ⓓ whether Sisyphus brought about his own punishment for glory

Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 37%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.10.R.1.4

Benchmark Description: Analyze how authors create multiple layers of meaning and/or ambiguity in a poem.

10. This question has two parts. First, answer Part A. Then, answer Part B.

Part A

What is the mood in Passage 3?

- Ⓐ peaceful
- Ⓑ smug
- Ⓒ vengeful
- Ⓓ weary

Part B

Which line from Passage 3 shows how the mood in Part A is developed through figurative language?

- Ⓐ “Drip, drap, drop, the gods cackled as I sweated on that hill.” (line 18)
- Ⓑ “Here, my lungs toil tirelessly, my limbs are lead” (line 25)
- Ⓒ “into the familiar dips and valleys of my boulder.” (line 36)
- Ⓓ “Finally, the kind of storied destiny I can truly embrace.” (line 38)

Answer Key: B and D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 21%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.10.R.3.1

Benchmark Description: Analyze how figurative language creates mood in text(s).

11. This question has two parts. First, answer Part A. Then, answer Part B.

Part A

How has the character of Sisyphus in Passage 3 changed from the original work in Passage 1?

- Ⓐ Sisyphus rests in peace.
- Ⓑ Sisyphus ends his suffering.
- Ⓒ Sisyphus retains his free will.
- Ⓓ Sisyphus disrespects the gods.

Part B

Select **two** lines from Passage 3 that support the answer in Part A.

- Ⓐ "I'll admit, the first few times were agony (pure anguish)." (line 15)
- Ⓑ "I could barely move that rock and felt my hope near-extinguish." (line 16)
- Ⓒ "Drip, drap, drop, the gods cackled as I sweated on that hill." (line 18)
- Ⓓ "Who—no, what would I be had I accepted my lot?" (line 31)
- Ⓔ "But this quiet kind of contentment, I dare not let show." (line 39)

Answer Key: C and D, E

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 18%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.10.R.3.3

Benchmark Description: Analyze how mythical, classical, or religious texts have been adapted.

Remarks at the 1964 Dedication of the Smithsonian Institution's Museum of History and Technology

by Lyndon B. Johnson

1 The gathering of knowledge is the supreme achievement of man.

2 Four hundred years ago, Francis Bacon could immodestly declare:
"I have taken all knowledge to be my province." Bacon would find this
new Museum of History and Technology of the Smithsonian Institution
to his taste, and to his aims.

3 For I believe this new museum will do that which causes us all to
celebrate: it will excite a thirst for knowledge—and to promote it for
all the people.

4 My earliest predecessor, George Washington, in a letter to the
officers of the American Philosophical Society, founded in Philadelphia
by Franklin, wrote these words:

5 "If I have a wish ungratified, it is that the arts and sciences may
continue to flourish with increasing lustre."

6 It was also Washington who said, in his Farewell Address:

7 "Promote, then, as an object of primary importance, institutions
for the general diffusion of knowledge. In proportion as the
structure of a government gives force to public opinion, it should be
enlightened."

8 So it pleases me a great deal tonight to come here to perform
the role of dedicator in this building of knowledge which is the inheritor
of all that has gone before.

9 Here, for all to see and for all to absorb, will be exhibited the
pageant of history of a youthful nation that is today as it was when
Jefferson described it: "In the full tide of successful experiment."

10 I would hope that there will come to this building the children of
the Nation. For here is recorded, as William Faulkner expressed it, the
agony and the sweat of the human spirit, the victory of the freedom
and the genius of our country. Here, young children see, with their
own eyes, yes, even touch with their own hands, the ripe fruit of
America's historical harvest.

11 Whitney's cotton gin, Singer's sewing machine, McCormick's
reaper, Edison's phonograph, Bell's telephone—they are all here, a part
of this treasure-house of our inheritance.

12 The more we understand the meaning of the past, the more we
appreciate the winning of the future.

- 13 I hope that every schoolchild who visits this Capital, every foreign visitor who comes to this First City, and every doubter who hesitates before the onrush of tomorrow will, some way, spend some time in this great museum. In truth, this new museum could become an open window through which could look the children of Asia and Western Europe and South America and the Soviet Union.
- 14 What greater thrust toward peace is there than the invitation to young people of the world, particularly those behind the Iron Curtain, to come visit us and to see this museum of history?
- 15 Why not open our historical doors and let the visitors see what kind of people we really are—and what sort of people we really come from?
- 16 They would instantly realize that we were not always the affluent nation and the powerful nation and the fortunate nation. From the exhibits in this museum they would learn that the demagogues' dingy slogans around the world have no real basis in fact.
- 17 Our ancestors moved across the prairies, working to build something where nothing existed before. Yes, this museum would show to the skeptics and the doubters that what we have today was wrenched out of the earth and the sweat of pioneers who, in the face of a thousand disappointments, refused to ever abandon the American dream.
- 18 We would show the visitors from the newly emerging nations that their labors are not in vain—for the future belongs to those who work for it. Let them go back to their home secure in the knowledge that from coarse and barren beginnings come the fulfillments of hope. They will have seen the evidence here.
- 19 If this museum did nothing more than illuminate our heritage so that others could see a little better our legacy, however so small the glimpse, it would fulfill a most noble purpose.
- 20 I am so glad to be here with you tonight.
- 21 I am always glad to be where America is.

"Remarks at the Dedication of the Smithsonian Institution's Museum of History and Technology"
by Lyndon B. Johnson. In the public domain.

12. Select the word that comes from the Latin root for “light, brightness.”

- 4 My earliest Ⓐ predecessor, George Washington, in a letter to the officers of the American Ⓑ Philosophical Society, founded in Philadelphia by Franklin, wrote these words:
- 5 “If I have a wish Ⓒ ungratified, it is that the arts and sciences may continue to Ⓓ flourish with increasing Ⓔ lustre.”

Answer Key: E

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 68%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.10.V.1.2

Benchmark Description: Apply knowledge of etymology and derivations to determine meanings of words and phrases in grade level content.

Florida Test Release Support Document

- 13.** Complete the table to indicate which role each section has in the development of ideas in the passage.

	Paragraph 1	Paragraphs 2–3	Paragraphs 4–7
establishing how museums can be considered patriotic	(A)	(B)	(C)
providing a claim about why the museum should be celebrated	(D)	(E)	(F)
placing the function of museums among humankind’s other accomplishments	(G)	(H)	(I)

Answer Key: C, E, G

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 41%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.10.R.2.1

Benchmark Description: Analyze the impact of multiple text structures and the use of features in text(s).

14. The word “diffusion” comes from the Latin word for “pour out.” Based on this information, what is the meaning of diffusion as it is used in paragraph 7?

- Ⓐ gathering
- Ⓑ leak
- Ⓒ research
- Ⓓ spread

Answer Key: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 71%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.10.V.1.2

Benchmark Description: Apply knowledge of etymology and derivations to determine meanings of words and phrases in grade level content.

15. How does Johnson use quotations to support his credibility?

- Ⓐ He implies that he is popular among his peers.
- Ⓑ He provides expert opinions on a topic unfamiliar to him.
- Ⓒ He shows he has considered the opinions of his opponents.
- Ⓓ He suggests that other notable figures would agree with him.

Answer Key: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 64%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.10.R.3.4

Benchmark Description: Analyze an author's use of rhetoric in a text.

16. How does paragraph 11 support the central idea that the museum will have an impressive collection?

- Ⓐ by listing the more expensive exhibits
- Ⓑ by describing the most popular exhibits
- Ⓒ by highlighting historically important exhibits
- Ⓓ by ranking the inventors responsible for the exhibits

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 76%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.10.R.2.2

Benchmark Description: Analyze the central idea(s) of historical American speeches and essays.

Florida Test Release Support Document

17. How do the rhetorical questions in paragraphs 14 and 15 support Johnson’s argument?

- Ⓐ They imply that Johnson is open to hearing suggestions from others.
- Ⓑ They imply that Johnson is telling the audience something they already know.
- Ⓒ They imply that Johnson is confident in his position about the museum’s importance.
- Ⓓ They imply that Johnson thinks some people may benefit more from the museum than others.

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 65%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.10.R.3.4

Benchmark Description: Analyze an author’s use of rhetoric in a text.

18. How does Johnson’s reference to other countries in paragraph 18 support his rhetoric?

- Ⓐ It appeals to logic by identifying which countries need help.
- Ⓑ It appeals to logic by emphasizing which countries he has visited.
- Ⓒ It appeals to emotions by identifying parallels with other countries.
- Ⓓ It appeals to emotions by emphasizing the barriers between countries.

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 57%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.10.R.3.4

Benchmark Description: Analyze an author’s use of rhetoric in a text.

19. Read these paragraphs from the passage.

20 I am so glad to be here with you tonight.

21 I'm always glad to be where America is.

How does the rhetoric in these paragraphs support Johnson's overall purpose?

- Ⓐ The logical appeal provides a new conclusion.
- Ⓑ The logical appeal summarizes the argument.
- Ⓒ The emotional appeal adds a final speculation.
- Ⓓ The emotional appeal creates a personal connection.

Answer Key: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 75%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.10.R.2.3

Benchmark Description: Analyze an author's choices in establishing and achieving purpose(s) in historical American speeches and essays.

20. Select **two** ways in which Johnson creates emotional appeals to support his purpose.

- ☒ Ⓐ He shares his hopes in order to be inspirational.
- ☐ Ⓑ He generalizes about countries in order to educate his audience.
- ☐ Ⓒ He uses the conditional “if” to express uncertainty about the future.
- ☐ Ⓓ He uses the general “they” in order to exclude people he does not like.
- ☒ Ⓔ He uses the plural “we” in order to encourage the audience to agree with him.

Answer Key: A, E

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 58%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.10.R.2.3

Benchmark Description: Analyze an author’s choices in establishing and achieving purpose(s) in historical American speeches and essays.

21. How does Johnson’s exaggeration throughout the passage support the central idea that the museum is necessary?

- ☒ (A) It suggests that the museum will have a strong impact on people.
- ☐ (B) It suggests that the museum will last for a long time into the future.
- ☐ (C) It suggests that the museum was created because he believed in it.
- ☐ (D) It suggests that the museum is unlike anything else already in existence.

Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 74%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.10.R.2.2

Benchmark Description: Analyze the central idea(s) of historical American speeches and essays.

***from* The Piano Lesson**

by August Wilson

Permissions were not secured for the use of this passage on a public website. For your reference, the citation for the passage and for items 23, 24, and 28 is as follows: August Wilson, *The Piano Lesson* (New York: New American Library, 1988, 1990), Act 1, Scene 2.

22. What does the dialogue in paragraphs 13–15 reveal about Boy Willie?
Select **two** answers.

- Ⓐ He secretly worries that he is doing the wrong thing.
- Ⓑ He is dismissive of others' concerns about his actions.
- Ⓒ He feels the need to keep people from becoming close to him.
- Ⓓ He appreciates hearing other peoples' thoughts before he acts.
- Ⓔ He needs to appear strong and in control in front of other people.

Answer Key: B, E

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 46%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.10.R.1.1

Benchmark Description: Analyze how key elements enhance or add layers of meaning and/or style in a literary text.

23. Read this paragraph from the passage.

20 BERNIECE: That's just what I'm gonna do. Wining Boy, you want me to fry you some pork chops?

How does this paragraph develop the universal themes of honoring the past and caring for family?

- Ⓐ by narrowing Berniece's focus to the family's tangible concerns
- Ⓑ by having Berniece exclude Boy Willie from a family discussion due to his lack of respect
- Ⓒ by showing that Berniece considers the desires of both her living and deceased family members
- Ⓓ by contrasting Berniece's and Boy Willie's willingness to let the other members of the family make the decision

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 46%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.10.R.1.2

Benchmark Description: Analyze and compare universal themes and their development throughout a literary text.

24. Read the sentences from the passage.

“Then that be something else, I’d have to go on and say, well, Berniece using that piano. She building on it. Let her go on and use it.”
(paragraph 21)

What is the meaning of the phrase “building on it” as it is used in the passage?

- Ⓐ designing something on top of
- Ⓑ purchasing something to match it
- Ⓒ establishing something by utilizing it
- Ⓓ constructing something out of the parts of

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 82%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.10.V.1.3

Benchmark Description: Apply knowledge of context clues, figurative language, word relationships, reference materials, and/or background knowledge to determine the connotative and denotative meaning of words and phrases, appropriate to grade level.

25. What effect does Berniece’s use of repetition in paragraph 22 have on the passage?

- Ⓐ It helps shift Berniece’s argument from the family’s past to its present.
- Ⓑ It shows that Berniece is unwilling to listen to the arguments of others.
- Ⓒ It reinforces the emotional weight that the piano held for Berniece’s mother.
- Ⓓ It supports the idea that Berniece is the best judge of what should happen to the piano.

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 76%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.10.R.1.1

Benchmark Description: Analyze how key elements enhance or add layers of meaning and/or style in a literary text.

26. How does paragraph 22 develop Boy Willie and Berniece’s different perspectives on the family? Select **two** answers.

- Ⓐ by showing that they each remember their childhoods very differently
- Ⓑ by showing that they each identify more closely with one of their parents
- Ⓒ by showing that they have learned competing lessons from their childhoods
- Ⓓ by showing that they have conflicting feelings about the importance of the family
- Ⓔ by showing that they have different reasons for wanting to spend less time with family

Answer Key: B, C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 10%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.10.R.1.3

Benchmark Description: Analyze coming of age experiences reflected in a text and how the author represents conflicting perspectives.

27. What effect does the connection between Sutter’s Ghost and the piano have on the passage?

- Ⓐ It provides an additional reason for the family to want the piano gone.
- Ⓑ It reinforces the idea that the past has an ongoing influence on the present.
- Ⓒ It indicates that the family only has a limited amount of time to make a decision.
- Ⓓ It suggests that keeping the piano will have unforeseen consequences for everyone.

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 71%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.10.R.1.1

Benchmark Description: Analyze how key elements enhance or add layers of meaning and/or style in a literary text.

28. This question has two parts. First, answer Part A. Then, answer Part B.

Part A

How does the passage develop the universal themes of accountability to family and the acceptance of responsibility?

- Ⓐ Berniece prefers to focus on taking care of others and ignores Boy Willie's questions about the piano.
- Ⓑ Berniece and Boy Willie each check with other members of the family to try to gain support for their plans.
- Ⓒ Berniece and Boy Willie both want to do what is right for their family but have different ideas of how to do that.
- Ⓓ Boy Willie finds an alternative method of getting money while Berniece refuses to consider their financial obligations.

Part B

Select **two** details from the passage that support the answer in Part A.

- Ⓐ "Just as soon as I get them watermelons out that truck." (paragraph 6)
- Ⓑ "This is me and Berniece's piano. Am I right, Doaker?" (paragraph 10)
- Ⓒ "Money can't buy what that piano cost. You can't sell your soul for money." (paragraph 18)
- Ⓓ "Papa Boy Charles brought that piano into the house. Now, I'm supposed to build on what they left me." (paragraph 21)
- Ⓔ "You always talking about your daddy but you ain't never stopped to look at what his foolishness cost your mama." (paragraph 22)

Answer Key: C and C, D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 33%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.10.R.1.2

Benchmark Description: Analyze and compare universal themes and their development throughout a literary text.

Passage 1: H.R. 51: Making D.C. the 51st State

by Representative Elijah E. Cummings

This is the opening statement of Representative Elijah E. Cummings of Maryland, chairman of the U.S. House Committee on Oversight and Reform, at a hearing about a bill to make certain portions of Washington, D.C., the 51st state of the United States.

1 I am extremely proud that our committee is holding the first hearing on D.C. Statehood in the House of Representatives in more than 25 years. Neither chamber of Congress has ever passed a Statehood bill. I hope ours will be the first.

2 H.R. 51 now has 220 cosponsors, which is a record for any previous D.C. Statehood bill. For the first time in a generation, there is real and sustained momentum behind this effort. This legislation would fulfill the promise of democracy for more than 700,000 Americans who call Washington, D.C., their home.

3 D.C. residents are American citizens. . . . They pay taxes. Not many people know this, but D.C. pays more in total Federal taxes than the residents of 22 states. And it pays more per capita than any state in the Nation.

4 D.C. residents have all of the responsibilities of citizenship, but they have no congressional voting rights and only limited self-government. These fundamental disparities for hundreds of thousands of Americans are inconsistent with the core principles embodied in our Constitution.

5 When our Nation was founded, it was based on the belief that no people should be subjected to taxation without representation or be governed without their consent. The Boston Tea Party was one of the most famous illustrations of this fight, refusing to accept laws and taxes in which they had no say.

6 Everyone on this panel, in this room, and across the country should be able to agree with this core value. . . .

7 There is nothing more fundamental in a democracy than the right to vote. As the Supreme Court has said—and I am quoting the Court—“No right is more precious in a free country than that of having a voice in the election of those who make the laws under which, as good citizens, we must live. Other rights, even the most basic, are illusory if the right to vote is undermined.”

8 In President Dwight D. Eisenhower’s 1956 State of the Union

address, he said this. “Once again, I ask the Congress to join with me in demonstrating our belief in the right of suffrage. I renew my request that the principle of self-government be extended and the right of suffrage granted to the citizens of the District of Columbia.”

9 Today, more than 60 years after President Eisenhower said those words, D.C. residents overwhelmingly support Statehood. In 2016, an astonishing 86 percent voted in favor of becoming a state.

10 The Congress now has an opportunity to live up to the Constitution’s goals. Statehood will give D.C. residents full and equal democratic rights. . . .

11 Today, I urge all members of this panel to rise above our partisan differences and think through this issue on the merits. I urge everyone to have a respectful and robust debate with the fundamental goals of our Founding Fathers at the forefront of our debate.

12 As President Abraham Lincoln declared in the Gettysburg Address, “A true democracy is government of the people, by the people, and for the people.”

Excerpt from “H.R. 51: Making D.C. the 51st State” by Representative Elijah E. Cummings, September 19, 2019. In the public domain.

Passage 2: Equality for the District of Columbia: Discussing the Implications of S. 132, the New Columbia Admission Act of 2013

by Senator Tom Coburn

This is the opening statement of U.S. Senator Tom Coburn of Oklahoma at a hearing about passing a bill to make a new state out of Washington, D.C., called “New Columbia.”

13 Since 1888, there have been hundreds of bills and amendments proposed to address D.C. representation. Since 1964, Congress has held no less than 10 hearings on it.

14 The House debated statehood in 1992. They heard from over a dozen witnesses and got another 20 opinions from every segment of the government.

15 Witnesses identified numerous problems, from constitutional to financial to administrative. The 1992 minority staff report does an excellent job of laying them out.

- 16 Yet here we are again debating this issue, even though it has no
chance of success in this chamber, and is dead on arrival in the House.
- 17 This bill makes a state out of the neutral land that houses the
Federal government. It's unprecedented.
- 18 Yet little effort was made to hold a hearing that seriously debates
this bill.
- 19 More than half the witnesses are D.C. politicians, all with the same
agenda and voicing the same interests.
- 20 With the exception of a witness I invited, none of the witnesses
here provide an alternate opinion.
- 21 You can learn a lot about the seriousness of this hearing by looking
at who is not here.
- 22 Where is the Department of Justice?
- 23 Every Department of Justice that has issued a report or testified
about legislated D.C. statehood—(Kennedy, Carter, Reagan, Bush, Sr.)
has concluded it is unconstitutional and would come with other
extremely complex legal challenges.
- 24 Where is CBO, OMB, the Interior, Transportation, State, Defense,
the General Services Administration, and Treasury?
- 25 D.C. statehood would significantly affect the Federal government's
operations including: use and access to water and sewer services,
utilities, police and fire services, infrastructure, communication
networks, D.C. National Guard, D.C.'s unfunded liabilities and other
benefits, and ability to control the aesthetics and condition of our
nation's capital.
- 26 D.C. statehood would also come at an unknown cost to the U.S.
- 27 Who is representing the interests of other states?
- 28 D.C. statehood would significantly affect the sovereignty of other
states, becoming the first among equals.
- 29 Nothing in the bill prevents New Columbia from still getting the
special funding D.C. gets, approximately \$674 million each year just
by virtue of being the nation's capital.
- 30 D.C. residents got more than eight times the national average of
federal aid per capita, and more than two times the next highest state.
- 31 Who is here to represent Virginia and Maryland?
- 32 There is a serious question as to whether Maryland's consent
would be necessary to create a new state, since it gave the land
to be the Capital.

- 33 The bill even gives New Columbia control over certain land in Virginia and Maryland, a serious affront to their sovereignty.
- 34 D.C. residents suffer an injustice by not having a vote, but Congress can't bypass the constitutional amendment process simply because it's inconvenient.
- 35 The framers¹ designed the district to be an autonomous federal area, separate from any state's influence and different from all other federal land. It is patently false to say the framers could not have predicted the city would thrive: the District was envisioned prior to 1800 as a large, powerful city with 800,000 people—more than D.C. has now, and more than even Paris had at the time.
- 36 President Kennedy's Attorney General² said Congress can't reduce the district's size any more than it can remove a state from the Union.
- 37 Attorney General Kennedy said a small enclave clearly does not meet the concept of the permanent seat of government, which the framers held.
- 38 President Reagan's Attorney General said he would recommend the President veto any bill providing statehood without a constitutional amendment.

¹framers: the authors of the Constitution

²President Kennedy's Attorney General: Robert F. Kennedy

Excerpt from "Equality for the District of Columbia: Discussing the Implications of S. 132, the New Columbia Admission Act of 2013" by Senator Tom Coburn, September 15, 2014. In the public domain.

29. Read this sentence from Passage 1.

“Other rights, even the most basic, are illusory if the right to vote is undermined.” (paragraph 7)

What is the meaning of illusory as it is used in this sentence?

- ☒ (A) meaningless
- ☐ (B) simplistic
- ☐ (C) unlawful
- ☐ (D) unwise

Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 82%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.10.V.1.3

Benchmark Description: Apply knowledge of context clues, figurative language, word relationships, reference materials, and/or background knowledge to determine the connotative and denotative meaning of words and phrases, appropriate to grade level.

30. In paragraphs 5 through 9 of Passage 1, how does Cummings support the central idea that a bill for D.C. statehood is ready to be passed?

- Ⓐ by emphasizing the hope that came from previous bills
- Ⓑ by explaining that the bill will reduce taxes on residents
- Ⓒ by demonstrating the demand for such a bill among citizens
- Ⓓ by claiming that members of Congress are eager to vote for the bill

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 54%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.10.R.2.2

Benchmark Description: Analyze the central idea(s) of historical American speeches and essays.

Florida Test Release Support Document

31. In Passage 1, what strategy does Cummings frequently use to add an emotional appeal to his argument?

- ☒ Ⓐ emphasizing American ideals
- ☐ Ⓑ investigating American history
- ☐ Ⓒ confirming American greatness
- ☐ Ⓓ presenting data about American voters

Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 49%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.10.R.3.4

Benchmark Description: Analyze an author's use of rhetoric in a text.

32. Select **two** approaches that Cummings uses to create a favorable opinion about H.R. 51 in Passage 1.

- Ⓐ sharing the expectation of greater government revenue
- Ⓑ fostering a sense of unified purpose among representatives
- Ⓒ presenting the bill as something that will correct an injustice
- Ⓓ demonstrating that the founders intended to make D.C. a state
- Ⓔ suggesting that passing the bill would help his colleagues get reelected

Answer Key: B, C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 37%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.10.R.2.3

Benchmark Description: Analyze an author's choices in establishing and achieving purpose(s) in historical American speeches and essays.

33. Read this sentence from Passage 2.

16 Yet here we are again debating this issue, even though it has no chance of success in this chamber, and is dead on arrival in the House.

How does the phrase “dead on arrival” contribute to the pessimistic mood of the passage?

- Ⓐ It generates fear.
- Ⓑ It inspires outrage.
- Ⓒ It establishes confusion.
- Ⓓ It expresses uselessness.

Answer Key: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 78%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.10.R.3.1

Benchmark Description: Analyze how figurative language creates mood in text(s).

34. In Passage 2, what is a reason Coburn uses short rhetorical questions starting in paragraph 22?

- Ⓐ to address complaints in the statehood bill
- Ⓑ to introduce arguments against the statehood bill
- Ⓒ to distract from the strengths of the statehood bill
- Ⓓ to downplay the power of the government to enact the statehood bill

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 55%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.10.R.2.3

Benchmark Description: Analyze an author's choices in establishing and achieving purpose(s) in historical American speeches and essays.

35. In paragraphs 23–25 of Passage 2, Coburn transitions from a history of failed bills to the effects of making D.C. a state. How does this strengthen his case?

- Ⓐ by establishing that such bills are unconstitutional
- Ⓑ by emphasizing the reasons such bills continue to fail
- Ⓒ by providing a contrast with arguments in favor of such bills
- Ⓓ by suggesting that such bills were never intended to pass as written

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 45%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.10.R.2.1

Benchmark Description: Analyze the impact of multiple text structures and the use of features in text(s).

36. Read this paragraph from Passage 2.

33 The bill even gives New Columbia control over certain land in Virginia and Maryland, a serious affront to their sovereignty.

What is the meaning of the phrase affront to their sovereignty in this context?

- Ⓐ violation of their laws
- Ⓑ attack on their traditions
- Ⓒ insult to their independence
- Ⓓ outrage against their senators

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 58%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.10.V.1.3

Benchmark Description: Apply knowledge of context clues, figurative language, word relationships, reference materials, and/or background knowledge to determine the connotative and denotative meaning of words and phrases, appropriate to grade level.

37. Select **two** ways in which Coburn argues that D.C. statehood would be unfair to the American people in Passage 2.

- Ⓐ by noting that not everyone is in favor of statehood
- Ⓑ by pointing out the area is not large enough to be a state
- Ⓒ by focusing on the financial difficulties statehood would create
- Ⓓ by implying that the new state would get preferential treatment
- Ⓔ by stating that the only people who support statehood are politicians

Answer Key: C, D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 29%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.10.R.2.2

Benchmark Description: Analyze the central idea(s) of historical American speeches and essays.

38. How do both speakers use information about early America to make their arguments?

- Ⓐ Both explain why D.C. was made the capital city.
- Ⓑ Both refer to the intentions of American founders.
- Ⓒ Both acknowledge the influence of European governments.
- Ⓓ Both portray Americans during the revolution as demanding.

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 65%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.10.R.2.4

Benchmark Description: Compare the development of two opposing arguments on the same topic, evaluating the effectiveness and validity of the claims, and analyzing the ways in which the authors use the same information to achieve different ends.

39. Complete the table to show how each passage develops its argument.

How Passage Develops Its Argument	Passage 1	Passage 2	Both Passages
by appealing to the values of democracy	(A)	(B)	(C)
by referring to principles of the Constitution	(D)	(E)	(F)
by using detailed specifics about related laws	(G)	(H)	(I)

Answer Key: A, F, H

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 23%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.10.R.2.4

Benchmark Description: Compare the development of two opposing arguments on the same topic, evaluating the effectiveness and validity of the claims, and analyzing the ways in which the authors use the same information to achieve different ends.